

Summer Internship Report

Report of Summer Internship Programme
2025 at CRY Foundation



Submitted By

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1. About the CRY Foundation

Established in 1979 by Rippan Kapur, an Air India purser, CRY began as "Child Relief and You" with the mission to address the challenges faced by marginalised children. Over the years, it has evolved into a rights-based organisation, focusing on systemic changes to create a conducive environment for children's development. Headquartered in Mumbai, CRY operates through branches in Bangalore, Chennai, Delhi, and Kolkata, collaborating with over 100 grassroots NGOs across 19 states in India.

1.1 Mission & Vision

Vision: CRY envisions "a happy, healthy, and creative child whose rights are protected and honoured in a society that is built on respect for dignity, justice, and equity for all."

Mission: CRY's mission is structured around three core objectives:

- **Taking Responsibility:** Encouraging individuals to acknowledge and address the challenges faced by deprived Indian children, motivating them to seek solutions through personal and collective action.
- **Mobilising Potential:** Empowering people to recognise their capacity for initiating change.
- **Inspiring Collective Action:** Facilitating the formation of diverse collectives and movements that collaborate to secure and uphold the rights of India's children.

1.2 Core Focus Areas

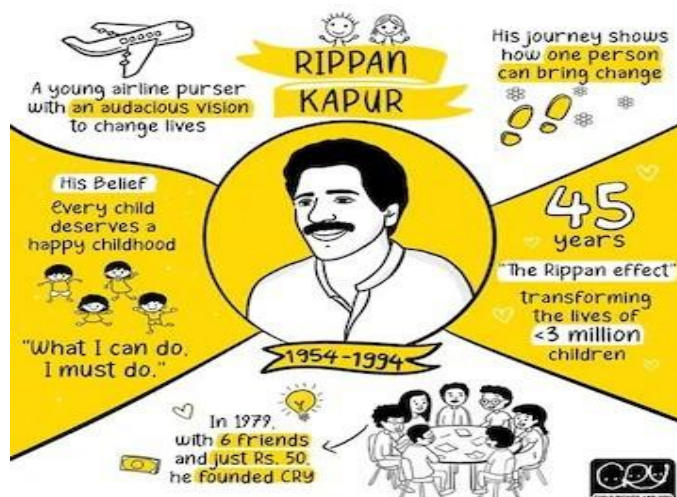
CRY's initiatives revolve around four fundamental rights of children:

- **Right to Survival:** Ensuring access to healthcare, nutrition, and a safe environment.
- **Right to Development:** Providing quality education and opportunities for personal growth.
- **Right to Protection:** Safeguarding children from abuse, exploitation, and neglect.
- **Right to Participation:** Encouraging children to express their views and participate in decisions affecting their lives.

1.3 Impact and Achievements

As of the 2023–24 period, CRY has positively impacted over 2.1 million underprivileged children in India. Notable achievements include: 94% of children aged 6–18 years in CRY project areas are enrolled in schools.

- 92% of children under 5 years are protected from undernourishment.
- 99% of adolescent girls aged 11–18 years are safeguarded against child marriage.
- 88% of children aged 6–18 years are protected from child labour. CRY's efforts have been recognised through various awards, such as the "Most Trusted NGO" in 2018 and inclusion among the "Top 100 Non-profits in the World" the same year.



2. Introduction

I am Devika Chugh, a Literature graduate and Teach for India fellow passionate about equity in education. Through this CRY internship, I aimed to contribute meaningfully to the lives of underserved children by facilitating engaging classroom sessions, strengthening community ties, and supporting the development of inclusive learning spaces. This internship allowed me to integrate my love for planning, facilitation, and visual learning tools into a real-world grassroots setting.

3. Internship Activities and Contributions

3.1. Classroom Facilitation and Planning

A core part of my internship involved **leading daily classroom sessions** for students in subjects such as English, Mathematics, Science, and Social-Emotional Learning (SEL). I was responsible for **planning, executing, and reflecting** on each session to ensure it was not only academically meaningful but also emotionally safe and engaging for every learner.

Key contributions included:

- Designing **weekly academic plans** that accounted for students' varied learning levels, attention spans, and interests.
- Creating **custom worksheets and visual learning aids** that supported differentiated instruction.
- Implementing **hands-on and movement-based strategies**—such as experiments, games, drawing, group storytelling, and role-plays—to make lessons more interactive and joyful.
- Observing and tracking student participation and growth over time, and **adjusting instruction** accordingly.

This experience strengthened my abilities as a facilitator, planner, and mentor while reaffirming the value of consistent structure and joy in education.



3.2 Community Visits and Parental Engagement

I conducted **regular community visits** across three different low-income neighborhoods, where I connected with children and their families. These visits offered invaluable insight into the lived realities of the students I taught and the systemic barriers they face.

My role during these visits included:

- **Engaging in one-on-one conversations** with parents and guardians about the importance of consistent attendance and learning continuity.
- **Listening to concerns** such as financial constraints, sibling care responsibilities, or migration that disrupted schooling.
- Identifying children who were **not attending regularly**, and discussing **possible solutions**.
- Collaborating with the team to **brainstorm and define objectives** for a community parent meeting, where caregivers and educators came together to build mutual understanding.
- Attending and **actively participating in the meeting**, ensuring parent voices were heard and respected.

These interactions helped me build **genuine partnerships with families** and understand education as a shared community responsibility.



3.3 Household Data Analysis

One of the most intellectually enriching and socially impactful components of my internship was the detailed analysis of a Household Baseline Survey dataset comprising over 800 entries. The goal was to derive actionable insights into community needs, educational barriers, and socio-economic vulnerabilities.

My contributions were multi-layered and included:

- **Data Cleaning & Categorization:** I organized and structured the dataset to ensure consistency and clarity. This involved standardizing variables such as housing type, sanitation facilities, access to education, and income brackets.
- **Analysis of Key Indicators:** I studied patterns in sanitation quality, housing structures, school enrollment rates, disability prevalence, and income levels to identify families at greater risk.
- **Data Visualization:** To make the findings accessible and impactful, I designed visually engaging graphs and charts, each clearly labelled and thoughtfully styled to reflect the insights accurately.
- **Contextual Policy Recommendations:** Based on trends observed, I developed grounded suggestions for future programming. These included:
 - Improving WASH (Water, Sanitation & Hygiene) infrastructure
 - Initiating community campaigns for re-enrollment and reducing dropouts
 - Addressing housing instability and its ripple effect on child learning
- **Documentation & Reporting:** I compiled the entire analysis including narrative interpretation, visual data, and proposed solutions, into a comprehensive report, complete with a professional cover page and layout.

This experience deepened my understanding of how data can tell stories, reveal inequalities, and drive child-centered policy and programming. It also strengthened my confidence in combining analytical thinking with social empathy.

3.4 Environment Day and Child Labour Day Contributions

As part of the centre's campaign activities, I helped plan and execute awareness efforts for two major observances:

World Environment Day

- Designed creative posters and slogans centered on sustainability and "Say No to Plastic."
- Supported students in preparing and performing a street play themed on environmental protection.
- Participated in a community rally, encouraging children to advocate for nature using chants, songs, and role-plays.
- Helped document the event through videos and photos.

International Child Labour Day

- Created visually powerful posters highlighting the importance of education and the right to childhood.

- Ensured the center was visually activated with awareness material, sparking conversations among students and community members.
 - Assisted in guiding students through related discussions in class.
- These experiences deepened my understanding of child rights advocacy through art, storytelling, and public participation.



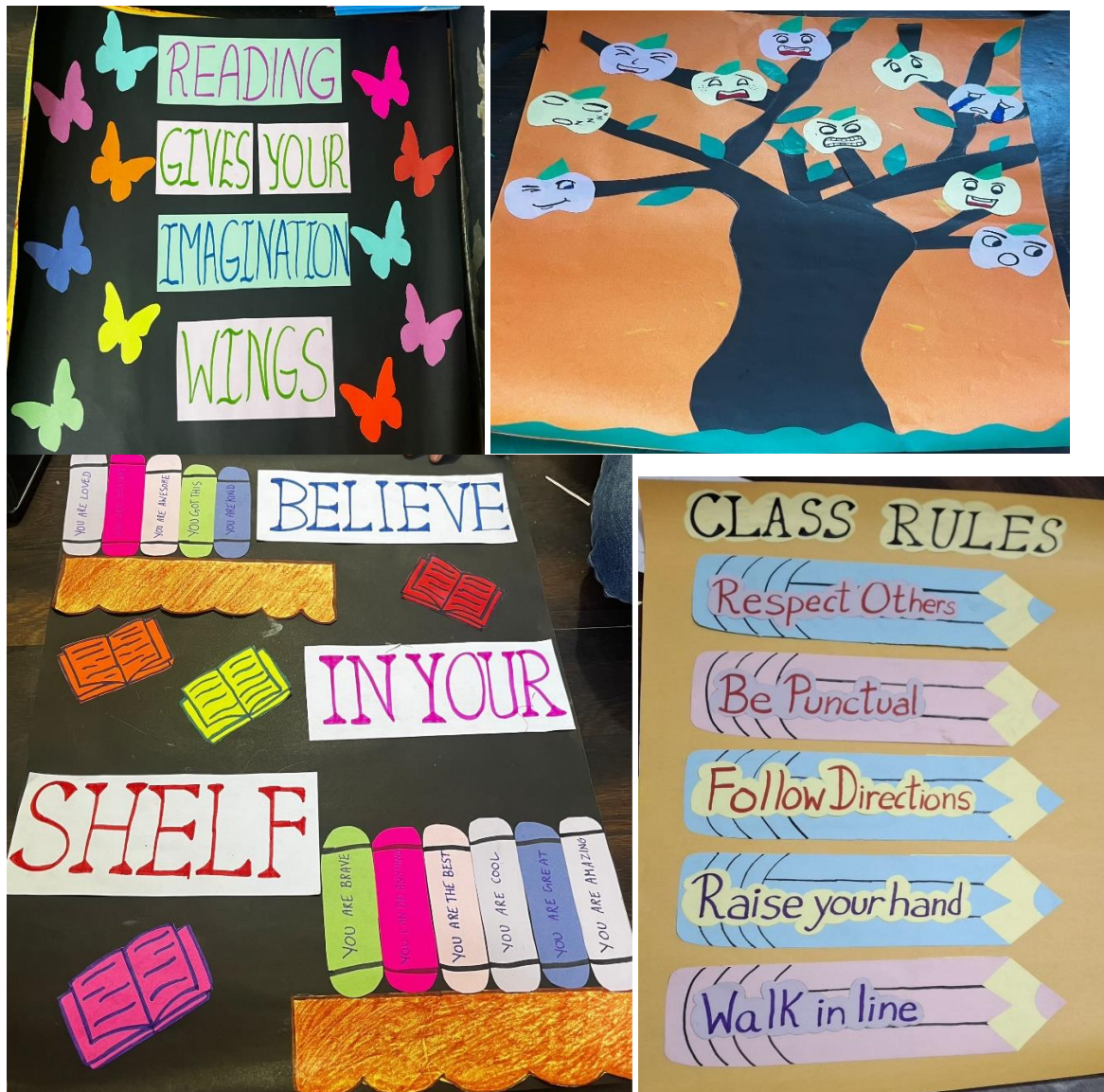
3.5 Library Decoration and Learning Space Enhancement

To promote a culture of reading and curiosity, I supported the design and decoration of the centre's library and learning spaces.

Specific contributions included:

- Creating and displaying student-friendly posters with motivational messages and reading prompts.
- Putting up posters and wall art across classrooms and common areas to visually reinforce values like kindness, resilience, and curiosity.

This effort enabled me to apply my creative thinking to spatial design and understand how visual environments can influence learning mindsets.



4. Key Learning and Takeaways

- Creative curriculum planning and differentiated instruction
- Building emotional safety and trust in classrooms
- Analyzing and interpreting large-scale household data
- Effective community and parent engagement
- Using design to make learning spaces more joyful and inclusive

5. Challenges and How I Overcame Them

Challenge	Response
Balancing daily teaching with planning time	I created weekly plans ahead and prepared worksheets in batches.
Keeping students engaged with varied energy levels	Used movement, hands-on tasks, and drawing to maintain attention.
Improving attendance through community visits	Built trust with parents and emphasized the center's benefits.
Handling and analyzing 800+ household records	Used structured spreadsheets and categorized insights for clarity.
Designing engaging visuals for the library	Maximized available materials and focused on bright, clear communication.

6. Conclusion

This internship allowed me to apply creativity, data literacy, and empathy in a grassroots setting. It was a transformative experience where I grew as an educator, communicator, and community partner. I leave with a deeper understanding of educational equity and a stronger commitment to creating inclusive learning environments.

7. Declaration

I hereby declare that the information furnished above is accurate to the best of my knowledge and reflects my true internship experience.

Signature: Devika Chugh

Date: 17/06/2025

8. References

CRY Foundation – <https://www.cry.org/>